

PROBLEM OF EVIL

FORMS OF EVIL → LOGICAL PROBLEM AND DEFENCE → SOUL-MAKING AND NATURAL ORDER → LEIBNIZ, AUGUSTINE AND PROCESS → EVIDENTIAL EVIL → INDIAN RESPONSE MATRIX

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g14 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

FORMS OF EVIL

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FREELY CAUSED CRUELTY, OPPRESSION, BETRAYAL

DISEASE, EARTHQUAKE, CONGENITAL SUFFERING

SUFFERING THAT THREATENS LIFE'S OVERALL MEANING

PAIN PREDATING HUMAN AGENCY

PROBLEM TYPES LOGICAL

GOD AND EVIL ARE STRICTLY INCONSISTENT EVIDENTIAL

AMOUNT/KINDS OF EVIL MAKE GOD IMPROBABLE EXISTENTIAL

natural: disease, earthquake, congenital suffering

→

horrendous: suffering that threatens life's overall meaning

→

animal/evolutionary: pain predating human agency

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• moral: freely caused cruelty, oppression, betrayal

• natural: disease, earthquake, congenital suffering

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• horrendous: suffering that threatens life's overall meaning

• animal/evolutionary: pain predating human agency

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• PROBLEM TYPES logical: God and evil are strictly inconsistent evidential: amount/kinds of evil make God improbable existential: suffering

• disrupts trust, worship and meaning.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Classify moral or natural evil and logical, evidential or existential burden before selecting any defence or theodicy.

01

STAGE 01

LOGICAL PROBLEM AND DEFENCE

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CLAIMED SET

OMNIPOTENT GOD + OMNISCIENT GOD + PERFECTLY GOOD GOD

A GOOD, POWERFUL BEING ELIMINATES EVERY EVIL IT CAN

PLANTINGA FREE-WILL DEFENCE SIGNIFICANT FREEDOM

POSSIBILITY OF MORAL WRONG

GOD CANNOT CAUSE A CREATURE TO CHOOSE FREELY AND COMPATIBILITY IS DEFENDED; ACTUAL QUANTITY OF EVIL IS NOT

PLANTINGA FREE-WILL DEFENCE significant freedom → possibility of moral wrong

→

God cannot cause a creature to choose freely and guarantee only right choices transworld depravity

→

RESULT: compatibility is defended; actual quantity of evil is not thereby explained.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• CLAIMED SET: omnipotent God + omniscient God + perfectly good God + evil exists missing premise: a good, powerful being eliminates every evil it can

• PLANTINGA FREE-WILL DEFENCE significant freedom → possibility of moral wrong

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• God cannot cause a creature to choose freely and guarantee only right choices transworld depravity shows logical possibility of unavoidable misuse

• RESULT: compatibility is defended; actual quantity of evil is not thereby explained.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• CLAIMED SET: omnipotent God + omniscient God + perfectly good God + evil exists missing premise: a good, powerful being eliminates every evil it can

• PLANTINGA FREE-WILL DEFENCE significant freedom → possibility of moral wrong

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RESULT: compatibility is defended; actual quantity of evil is not thereby explained.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Mackie's triad needs evil-prevention bridges; Plantinga restores possible compatibility without explaining the actual quantity of suffering.

02

STAGE 02

SOUL-MAKING AND NATURAL ORDER

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JOHN HICK EPISTEMIC DISTANCE + STABLE NATURAL LAWS +

GENUINE AGENCY STRUGGLE

COURAGE, COMPASSION, RESPONSIBILITY

PERSON-MAKING STRENGTH

ADDRESSES WHY A READY-MADE PARADISE MAY DEFEAT MATURE FREEDOM

VICTIMS USED AS MEANS: SUFFERING IS EXCESSIVE AND UNEVEN INFANTS, ANIMALS AND HORRORS DO NOT RELIABLY IMPROVE SUFFERERS

suffering is excessive and uneven

→

infants, animals and horrors do not reliably improve sufferers reply requires afterlife fulfilment/universal restoration, which

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• IRENAEUS / JOHN HICK epistemic distance + stable natural laws + risk → genuine agency struggle → courage,

• suffering is excessive and uneven

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• infants, animals and horrors do not reliably improve sufferers reply requires afterlife fulfilment/universal restoration, which adds further commitments.

• IRENAEUS / JOHN HICK epistemic distance + stable natural laws + risk → genuine agency struggle → courage,

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• suffering is excessive and uneven

• infants, animals and horrors do not reliably improve sufferers reply requires afterlife fulfilment/universal restoration, which adds further commitments.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Soul-making links epistemic distance and stable law to virtue, but must answer excess, unequal distribution and victim-instrumentalisation.

03

STAGE 03

LEIBNIZ, AUGUSTINE AND PROCESS REVISIONS

LEIBNIZ, AUGUSTINE AND PROCESS REVISIONS

EVIL IS PRIVATIO BONI, NOT A CREATED SUBSTANCE; MISUSE

BEST POSSIBLE WORLD BALANCES LAWS, FREEDOM AND TOTAL COMPOSSIBILITY

GOD MAY PERMIT EVIL FOR A GREATER GOOD, NEVER

PROCESS THEISM

GOD PERSUADES BUT CANNOT UNILATERALLY PREVENT EVERY EVENT PRIVATION DOES NOT LESSEN FELT HORROR; "BEST" CAN SEEM GREATER-GOOD REASONING RISKS INSTRUMENTALISING VICTIMS; PROCESS VIEW REVISES OMNIPOTENCE.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

AUGUSTINE: evil is privatio boni, not a created substance; misuse of freedom disorders good

LEIBNIZ: best possible world balances laws, freedom and total compossibility

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

AQUINAS: God may permit evil for a greater good, never will evil as evil

PROCESS THEISM: God persuades but cannot unilaterally prevent every event

EVALUATION / TRAP

COSTS: privation does not lessen felt horror; "best" can seem complacent

greater-good reasoning risks instrumentalising victims; process view revises omnipotence.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

• AUGUSTINE: evil is privatio boni, not a created substance; misuse of freedom disorders good

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EVALUATION / TRAP

• COSTS: privation does not lessen felt horror; "best" can seem complacent

• greater-good reasoning risks instrumentalising victims; process view revises omnipotence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Privation, best-world, greater-good and process replies preserve different attributes and incur different moral or theological costs.

04

STAGE 04

EVIDENTIAL EVIL

EVIDENTIAL EVIL

APPARENTLY POINTLESS SUFFERING EXISTS; AN OMNIPOTENT GOOD GOD WOULD

THEREFORE GOD'S EXISTENCE IS IMPROBABLE HIDDEN FAWN CASE TESTS

SKEPTICAL THEISM

LIMITED HUMAN COGNITION CANNOT INFER "NO REASON" FROM "NO

ABSENCE OF EVIDENCE IS EVIDENCE ONLY WHERE DETECTION SHOULD TOO MUCH SCEPTICISM ALSO WEAKENS PROVIDENTIAL AND MORAL REASONING

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• ROWE: apparently pointless suffering exists; an omnipotent good God would prevent it

• therefore God's existence is improbable hidden fawn case tests gratuitous natural suffering without human freedom

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• SKEPTICAL THEISM: limited human cognition cannot infer "no reason" from "no reason seen"

• CORNEA: absence of evidence is evidence only where detection should be expected objection: too much scepticism also weakens

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• providential and moral reasoning verdict must weigh epistemic humility against the specificity of apparently gratuitous evil.

• ROWE: apparently pointless suffering exists; an omnipotent good God would prevent it

MECHANISM / VERDICT — CORNEA: absence of evidence is evidence only where detection should be expected objection: too much scepticism also weakens providential and moral reasoning verdict must weigh epistemic humility against the specificity of apparently gratuitous evil.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rowe treats apparently gratuitous suffering as evidence; CORNEA blocks the noseum inference only at the risk of wider moral scepticism.

05

STAGE 05

INDIAN RESPONSE MATRIX

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SUFFERING BELONGS TO VYAVAHĀRIKA AVIDYĀ; ULTIMATE BRAHMAN IS NON-DUAL

REAL SOULS/WORLD, KARMA, GRACE AND PURPOSEFUL DIVINE ORDER

BEGINNINGLESS KARMA ALLOCATED BY ĪŚVARA; GOD IS NOT ARBITRARY

KARMIC MATTER BINDS JĪVA: NO CREATOR BEARS RESPONSIBILITY DUHKHA FROM DEPENDENT ORIGATION, CRAVING AND IGNORANCE; NO CREATOR KARMA EXPLAINS MORAL CONTINUITY BUT FACES FIRST-ORIGIN, VICTIM-BLAMING AND

LIBERATION ROUTES ANSWER SUFFERING THERAPEUTICALLY, NOT ALWAYS AS A

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

ADVAITA: suffering belongs to vyāvahārika avidyā; ultimate Brahman is non-dual

VIŚIṢṬĀDVAITA: real souls/world, karma, grace and purposeful divine order

NYĀYA: beginningless karma allocated by īśvara; God is not arbitrary author of deserts

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

JAINA: karmic matter binds jīva; no creator bears responsibility

BUDDHISM: duhkha from dependent origination, craving and ignorance; no creator problem

KARMA explains moral continuity but faces first-origin, victim-blaming and natural-evil pressures

EVALUATION / TRAP

liberation routes answer suffering therapeutically, not always as a theodicy.

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EVALUATION / TRAP

• liberation routes answer suffering therapeutically, not always as a theodicy.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Beginningless karma addresses distribution without licensing retrospective blame; Indian systems differ over creator, self and causal mechanism.

06

STAGE 06

HARD CASES AND ETHICAL LIMITS

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TEST ANY THEODICY AGAINST CHILD SUFFERING

ANIMAL PAIN

UNEQUAL OPPORTUNITY

DOES RESPONSE EXPLAIN, MERELY DEFEND LOGICAL POSSIBILITY, OR OFFER

DOES IT PRESERVE VICTIM DIGNITY? DOES IT MAKE PREVENTABLE

ANTI-THEODICY WARNING

NEAT JUSTIFICATION CAN REPEAT HARM REPLY

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

TEST ANY THEODICY AGAINST child suffering

animal pain

unequal opportunity

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

ASK: does response explain, merely defend logical possibility, or offer pastoral meaning?

does it preserve victim dignity? does it make preventable evil morally acceptable?

anti-theodicy warning: neat justification can repeat harm reply: philosophical explanation need not command passive acceptance

EVALUATION / TRAP

moral protest may itself express commitment to goodness.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

• TEST ANY THEODICY AGAINST child suffering

• animal pain

• unequal opportunity

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

• ASK: does response explain, merely defend logical possibility, or offer pastoral meaning?

• does it preserve victim dignity? does it make preventable evil morally acceptable?

• anti-theodicy warning: neat justification can repeat harm reply: philosophical explanation need not command passive acceptance

EVALUATION / TRAP

• moral protest may itself express commitment to goodness.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hard cases test whether a response offers compatibility, explanation, justification or pastoral meaning while preserving victim dignity.

07

STAGE 07

PYQ AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS

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DEFINE GOD-CONCEPT + EVIL TYPE

SEPARATE LOGICAL/EVIDENTIAL/EXISTENTIAL DEMAND

FORMAL ARGUMENT

STRONGEST DEFENCE/THEODICY

HARD-CASE OBJECTION

INDIAN COMPARISON ON KARMA/DUHKHA

10 MARKS

DEFINE God-concept + evil type → separate logical/evidential/existential demand → formal argument → strongest defence/theodicy → hard-case → Indian comparison on karma/duhkha → qualified verdict → 10 marks: one problem + one response + evaluation → 15 marks: logical/evidential distinction + two responses

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• DEFINE God-concept + evil type → separate logical/evidential/existential demand

• formal argument → strongest defence/theodicy → hard-case objection

• Indian comparison on karma/duhkha → qualified verdict

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• 10 marks: one problem + one response + evaluation

• 15 marks: logical/evidential distinction + two responses

• 20 marks: Western and Indian matrix + hard cases + concept revision

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• CLOSE: evil may not disprove every God-concept, but it severely tests classical omni-God belief and forces costs in

• freedom, providence, power, afterlife or human understanding.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A strong conclusion is version-specific: evil may not strictly disprove every God-concept while remaining severe evidence against classical theism.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ADVANCED-DOSSIER RECONCILIATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

ADVANCED SEMINAR MODULES - FROM COMPETENT TO EXAMINER-GRADE

THE SECTION DOSSIER MARKS SKEPTICAL THEISM AND HORRENDOUS EVILS

TEACHES CORNEA, REPRESENTATIVENESS, BALANCING-OFF VERSUS DEFEAT, AND GOODNESS-TO-PERSONS.

THEIR OPTIONAL RESIDUE IS SECOND-ORDER

WHETHER A POSITIVE THEODICY CAN BE COMBINED CONSISTENTLY WITH

DEFEAT WITHIN A SUFFERER'S LIFE IS STILL A GENERAL

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

• Advanced-dossier reconciliation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

• Advanced Seminar Modules - From Competent to Examiner-Grade

• The section dossier marks skeptical theism and horrendous evils as promoted to core because the owner source now

• teaches CORNEA, representativeness, balancing-off versus defeat, and goodness-to-persons.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

• Their optional residue is second-order: whether a positive theodicy can be combined consistently with global skepticism, and whether

• defeat within a sufferer's life is still a general theodicy.

• Free-will treatment of natural evil and victim-blaming critiques of karma remain high-value comparative refinements, not stand-alone catalogues.

• Modal logic without notation overload ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM High-value transition: The logical problem is

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

• a question about whether the relevant propositions can be true.

• [THESIS] The logical problem is a question about whether the relevant propositions can be true together in at least one possible world.

• [ARGUMENT] Three modal ideas must be kept separate.

• First, logical possibility means that a description contains no contradiction.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.